

Governance Policy

SECTION 1: PURPOSE

1 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Governance Policy is to define the governance framework, roles, and responsibilities of Chosanta Management. This policy ensures that the organisation operates in line with the Health Act 2007, the National Standards for Residential Services for Children and Adults with Disabilities, and all other applicable regulatory frameworks.

Governance is the system by which the service is directed, controlled, and held accountable. It ensures that the organisation delivers safe, effective, and person-centred care to all individuals supported.

This policy is designed to:

- ✓ Ensure a clear line of accountability across all levels of leadership and service delivery
- ✓ Promote transparent decision-making based on legal, ethical, and best-practice frameworks
- ✓ Establish systems for monitoring performance, managing risk, and safeguarding people who use the service
- ✓ Support continuous quality improvement through leadership, planning, oversight, and communication
- ✓ Ensure that roles such as the Registered Provider, Person in Charge (PIC), and Governance Officer are fully defined, resourced, and understood



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SECTION 2: GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

2 GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

Chosanta Management operates under a clearly defined governance structure that ensures effective leadership, oversight, and accountability across all levels of the organisation.

Key Governance Roles:

- ✓ **Registered Provider:** Chosanta Management — holds legal responsibility for regulatory compliance, financial integrity, and the quality of care provided across all centres
- ✓ **Director:** Leads on strategic governance, risk oversight, and ensures effective resourcing of all operations and staffing
- ✓ **Operational Governance Officer:** Supports day-to-day compliance with HIQA regulations; oversees internal audits, policy reviews, and liaises with external authorities
- ✓ **Person in Charge (PIC):** Named individual responsible for direct management of the designated centre; accountable for care delivery, safeguarding, supervision, and compliance
- ✓ **Designated Centre(s):** HIQA-registered accommodation supporting adults, operated in accordance with Section 69 of the Health Act 2007

Review Cycle:

- ✓ Annually as part of the quality improvement plan
- ✓ Immediately following any material organisational change
- ✓ In response to recommendations from HIQA or internal audits

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SECTION 3: RESPONSIBILITIES

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Registered Provider:** Overall accountability for the designated centre; ensures compliance with the Health Act 2007; oversees appointment and performance of the PIC; provides appropriate resources
- ✓ **Director:** Provides strategic direction and oversight of governance, finance, and service delivery; conducts annual governance reviews; monitors compliance with policies and risk management
- ✓ **Operational Governance Officer:** Oversees internal audits, policy compliance, and continuous improvement; acts as lead liaison with HIQA inspectors; provides escalation support for safeguarding, staffing, or risk issues
- ✓ **Person in Charge (PIC):** Manages day-to-day operations; ensures care is delivered in line with personal plans and national standards; supervises staff; maintains records and submits notifications
- ✓ **Multidisciplinary & Support Staff:** Work collaboratively under the PIC; participate in training, supervision, and team meetings; adhere to policies and support residents to achieve goals

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SECTION 4: GOVERNANCE REVIEW

4 GOVERNANCE REVIEW

Chosanta Management conducts ongoing and structured governance reviews to ensure the effectiveness of leadership, compliance with regulatory requirements, and continuous improvement.

Review Frequency:

- ✓ Formal Governance Reviews are held quarterly
- ✓ A comprehensive annual review is conducted each calendar year
- ✓ Extraordinary reviews may be held following serious incidents or HIQA inspections

Scope of Review:

- ✓ Legal and regulatory compliance
- ✓ Leadership structure and oversight effectiveness
- ✓ Audit findings and follow-up actions
- ✓ Quality of resident care, staff supervision, and development
- ✓ Incident and complaint management
- ✓ Health & safety, budgeting, and resource use

Outcomes:

- ✓ Drives quality improvements and updates policies
- ✓ Supports risk mitigation planning
- ✓ Enhances staff training and support
- ✓ Provides inspection-ready governance evidence

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SECTION 5: GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE REVIEW MEETING TEMPLATE

5 MEETING AGENDA TEMPLATE

- ✓ 1. Welcome & Opening Remarks
- ✓ 2. Review of Previous Minutes & Actions
- ✓ 3. Regulatory Compliance Update — HIQA correspondence, notifications (Reg 31/32), policy updates
- ✓ 4. Safeguarding & Risk Register — incidents, allegations, current concerns, escalations & trends
- ✓ 5. Quality & Safety — complaints log, resident/family feedback, infection control, audits, medication
- ✓ 6. Staffing & Training — supervision records, training matrix & gaps, recruitment/rota issues
- ✓ 7. Resident Outcomes & Personal Planning — reviews completed, independent advocacy reports
- ✓ 8. Environmental & Health & Safety — fire safety checks, repairs, equipment, maintenance
- ✓ 9. Finance & Resources — budget updates, procurement needs
- ✓ 10. Strategic / Business Updates — SLA/HSE feedback, funding or expansion planning
- ✓ 11. Action Plan — assigned actions, timelines, and leads
- ✓ 12. Next Meeting Date